

Thomas Edison

A prolific inventor whose ideas helped to make the world a much **BRIGHTER** place for everybody

All about me

- **BORN:** 1847
- **DIED:** 1931
- **NATIONALITY:** American
- **FACTOID:** I patented almost 1,100 inventions.
- **IN A NUTSHELL:** I was born in Ohio, USA. By the time I was 12, I was almost completely deaf. I didn't really mind though—it helped me to concentrate!

By the way...
I also held patents for the phonograph (a music player) and a kinetograph (motion picture recorder).

A thin wire (filament) glows when electricity is passed through it.

Let there be light

The **FILAMENTS** of early light bulbs were too bright and burned out after just a few hours. Edison did **4,700 experiments** to find a better material and, in 1879, he tried using carbon and created a light bulb that lasted 1,500 hours, ***making the bulb practical for the first time ever.***

Electric revolution

To make his invention useful, people needed an **ELECTRICITY SUPPLY**. So Edison invented a way to produce electricity and distribute it through wires into homes and businesses. In 1882, he built the first public power station, the ***Edison Electric Light Station*** in London, England, and eight months later, he built America's first power station in New York. By the 1890s, **hundreds of towns** throughout the world had Edison power stations, and soon electricity became part of everyday life.

